suppression of the impure elements of existence, which have been rendered inoperative in relation to the skilled meditator. Meditation upon the transitory and composite (that is, not truly real) nature of everything experienced prevents the arising of future conditioned ***dharmas*** in a psycho-physical stream. *Parinirvana* or ultimate extinction occurs at death. The life in the world of the enlightened one (*arhat*) continues until the five constituents of personality (***Skandhas***: matter and form, feelings, perceptions, dispositions and conscious acts) are expended or 'burnt out'. After the death of the enlightened one, there is neither rebirth nor any form of experience.

The later south-east Asian *Mahayana* Buddhist traditions tend to understand *nirvana* more positively as an enlightened way of being in the world, total extinction being a remote horizon. The *Bodhisattva* (enlightened being), having realised the insubstantiality of all phenomena and the vanity of one's sense of self, is moved by compassion to bring to *nirvana* all suffering, transmigrating beings. A modern example is the Dalai Lama.

Further reading: Gombrich 1996; Williams 1989

Nirvikalpaka-pratyaksha (concept-free perception): after the Buddhist thinker ***Dignaga***, who held that perceptual sensation and conceptual thought were completely different, ***Nyaya*** and ***Purva Mimamsa*** realist philosophers respond by distinguishing between two types of perception. The first is non-conceptual (*nirvikalpa*) awareness, arising from sensory impressions, of the object as an undifferentiated whole. This does not involve explicit recognition of the object's general and specific features. ***Kumarila Bhatta*** says that first there is observation, which is non-conceptual. It is produce by the pure object and is like the awareness of infants and mute people. The information received in pre-conceptual perception is translated into